

The Harbinger's Reflections on the Decline of the Guild

To Jorm, trusted shield brother

Brother, I see clearly the path we are walking. Many speak of strength as if it were an absolute virtue. Yet the history of the North is filled with peoples who were strong... and nonetheless vanished. The Snow Elves did not fall only beneath the axes of our ancestors. They fell because something within them broke long before their walls did. When a people lose their bond with what they hold sacred, a descent begins that no sword can halt. It is not always a divine punishment. Sometimes it is a slow fading, like snow beneath a sun that cannot be seen. I have studied the tales of their gods, of the temples that shone in the mountains, and of prayers said to be able to still the winter itself. If any of this is true, then their ruin was not merely material. It was spiritual. A gradual estrangement from their own origin. And here I find a warning for us. We do not need curses or dark magic to fall into oblivion. It is enough to forget why we fight. Enough to let glory replace meaning. Enough to stop listening to the silence between one battle and the next. The Snow Elves became unrecognizable not because they were transformed... but because they ceased to recognize themselves. This is the true fall. Not defeat. Not the loss of land. But the moment when memory can no longer sustain identity. If their gods abandoned them, perhaps it was not out of cruelty. Perhaps it happened because there was no one left able to hear them. We, who call ourselves Companions, must guard against this more than against any enemy. For walls can be rebuilt. Weapons reforged. Wounds healed. But when a people forget themselves, no smith can save them. And then the snow, which once held their songs, becomes only silence.

Brother Dainn